To connect our front end to Michael's database, we need something called mysql2, which lets our Node.js server send information to MySQL. Basically, when someone fills out a form like Create Account, Express (our server) grabs that info and mysql2 sends it to the database to be saved.

To set it up, we just run npm install mysql2 and connect it using our database info (host, username, password, database name). After that, we can write code that saves new users whenever someone submits a form.

One thing I learned is that we shouldn't plug form info directly into the database query, because that can let someone type something harmful into a form field and mess with our database. Instead we use placeholders (?) to keep it safe. Once we get this working, I want to test it by typing weird or unexpected stuff into the form fields to make sure nothing breaks.

What we need next:

Paris's account creation form currently goes to create_account.html using GET, but it needs to use POST and actually connect to our server instead of just a regular HTML page.

After that's set up, I can test that the form actually saves data correctly into Michael's User table, and that bad input doesn't cause problems